



AUTOMATING SENTINEL TRIAGE WITH MICROSOFT SECURITY COPILOT

ANTHONY PORTER



WHO AM I?

Anthony Porter

Cloud Security Architect

Canon Business Services ANZ

Blog: <https://www.securingm365.com>

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/AnthonyAntoPorter>

GitHub: <https://www.github.com/AntoPorter>

Podcast: Out of Band: A Microsoft Security Podcast



AGENDA



Microsoft Sentinel

+



Microsoft Security Copilot

WHAT IS SENTINEL?

Comprehensive Threat Detection

Aggregates data from multiple sources for enhanced monitoring.

Incident Response Capabilities

Provides actionable insights and automated workflows.

Data Aggregation and Insights

Collects and analyzes data to improve security posture.



WHAT IS SECURITY COPILOT? AN AI-POWERED SECURITY ASSISTANT



AI Powered Security

Enhances security professionals' efficiency with advanced AI.

Insights and Suggestions

Provides actionable insights to improve response times.

Incident Analysis Efficiency

Enhances analysis efficiency for faster issue resolution.

Seamless Integration

Works with Microsoft Defender XDR, Purview, and Intune.

WHAT'S A SCU?

(SECURITY COMPUTE UNIT)

The SCU is an integral part of the Security Copilot architecture, supporting the overall security automation infrastructure.

Provisioned Capacity

Billed hourly for regular workloads.

Overage Capacity

Billed based on usage for unexpected demand.

Resource Management

Ensures efficient and predictable performance.

SOAR: AUTOMATED RESPONSE

Automated Responses

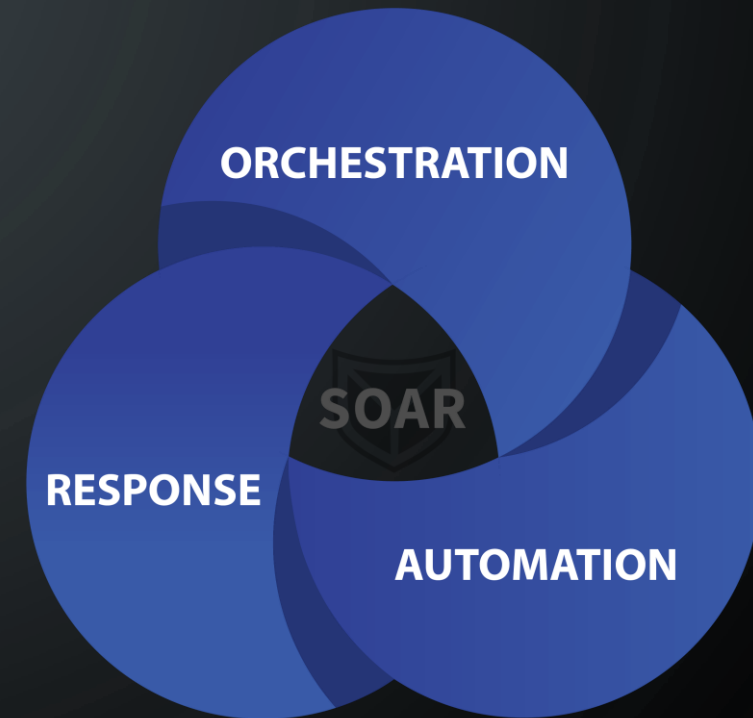
Faster resolution times through automated incident responses.

Enhanced Operational Efficiency

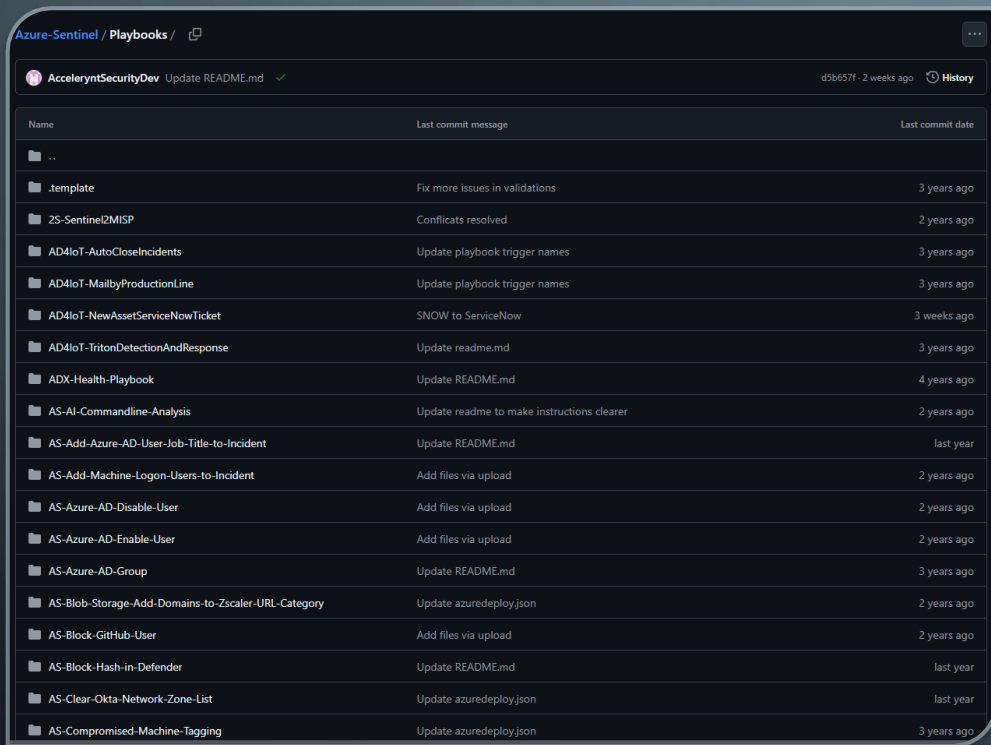
Automation of routine tasks allows focus on complex issues.

Faster Incident Response

Reduced response times, improving overall security posture.



PLAYBOOKS: AUTOMATING WORKFLOWS VIA LOGIC APPS



The screenshot displays the Azure Sentinel Playbooks page. At the top, it shows the breadcrumb 'Azure-Sentinel / Playbooks' and a status bar for 'AccelerantSecurityDev' with a green checkmark and the message 'Update README.md'. Below this is a table listing various playbooks with their names, last commit messages, and last commit dates.

Name	Last commit message	Last commit date
..		
.template	Fix more issues in validations	3 years ago
2S-Sentinel2MISP	Conflicats resolved	2 years ago
AD4IoT-AutoCloseIncidents	Update playbook trigger names	3 years ago
AD4IoT-MailbyProductionLine	Update playbook trigger names	3 years ago
AD4IoT-NewAssetServiceNowTicket	SNOW to ServiceNow	3 weeks ago
AD4IoT-TritonDetectionAndResponse	Update readme.md	3 years ago
ADX-Health-Playbook	Update README.md	4 years ago
AS-AI-Commandline-Analysis	Update readme to make instructions clearer	2 years ago
AS-Add-Azure-AD-User-Job-Title-to-Incident	Update README.md	last year
AS-Add-Machine-Logon-Users-to-Incident	Add files via upload	2 years ago
AS-Azure-AD-Disable-User	Add files via upload	2 years ago
AS-Azure-AD-Enable-User	Add files via upload	2 years ago
AS-Azure-AD-Group	Update README.md	3 years ago
AS-Blob-Storage-Add-Domains-to-Zscaler-URL-Category	Update azuredeploy.json	2 years ago
AS-Block-GitHub-User	Add files via upload	2 years ago
AS-Block-Hash-in-Defender	Update README.md	last year
AS-Clear-Okta-Network-Zone-List	Update azuredeploy.json	last year
AS-Compromised-Machine-Tagging	Update azuredeploy.json	3 years ago

Automated Security Operations

Streamline tasks, focus on critical incidents.

Swift Incident Response

Predefined actions for quick and effective responses.

Integration with Logic Apps

Seamless integration enhances workflow automation.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE: GETTING STARTED WITH SOAR

1. Setup Logic Apps

Open Sentinel, go to Automation, click "Create".

2. Set Triggers

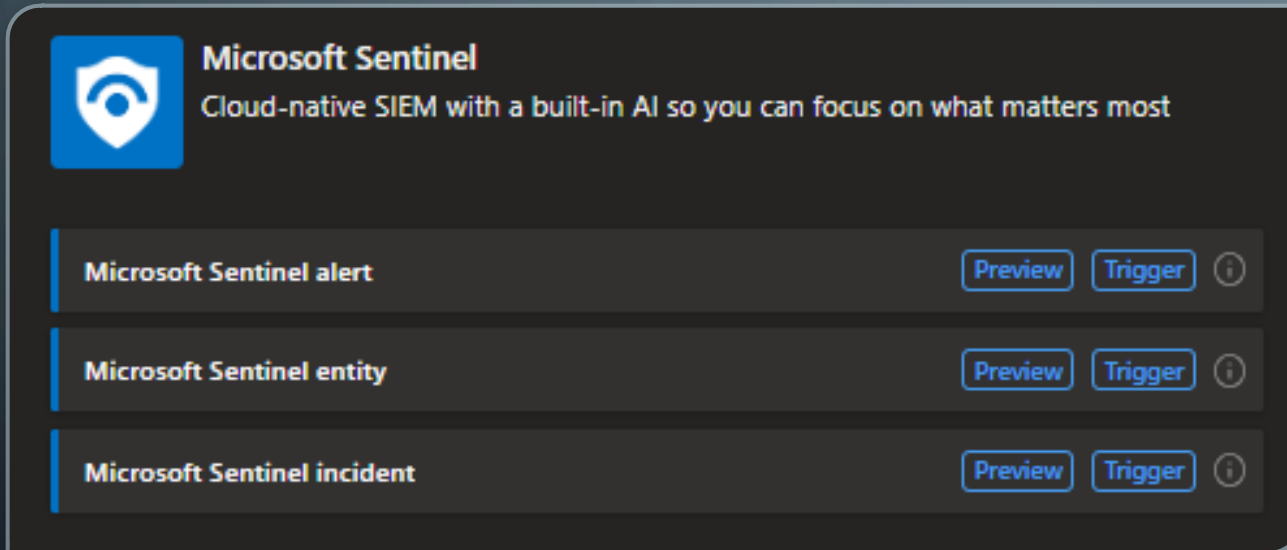
Choose and configure triggers based on events.

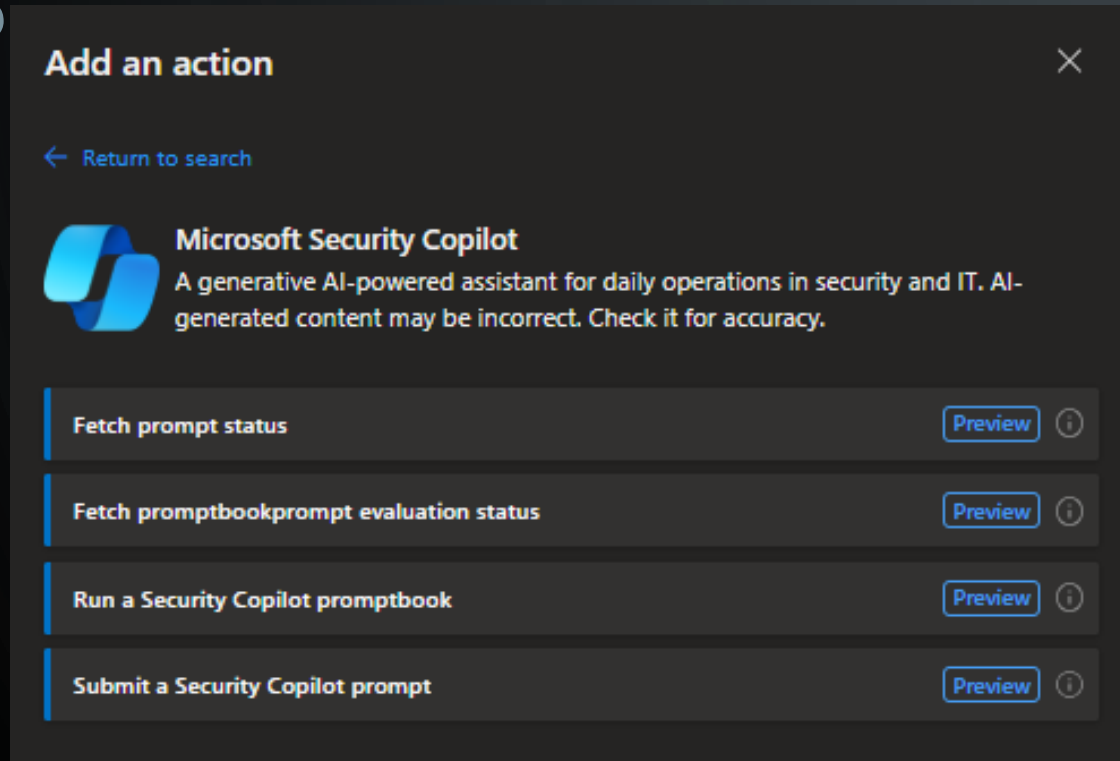
3. Define Actions

Select actions (alerts, updates, scripts), test them.

4. Finalize & Test

Review, save, activate, and test the Playbook.





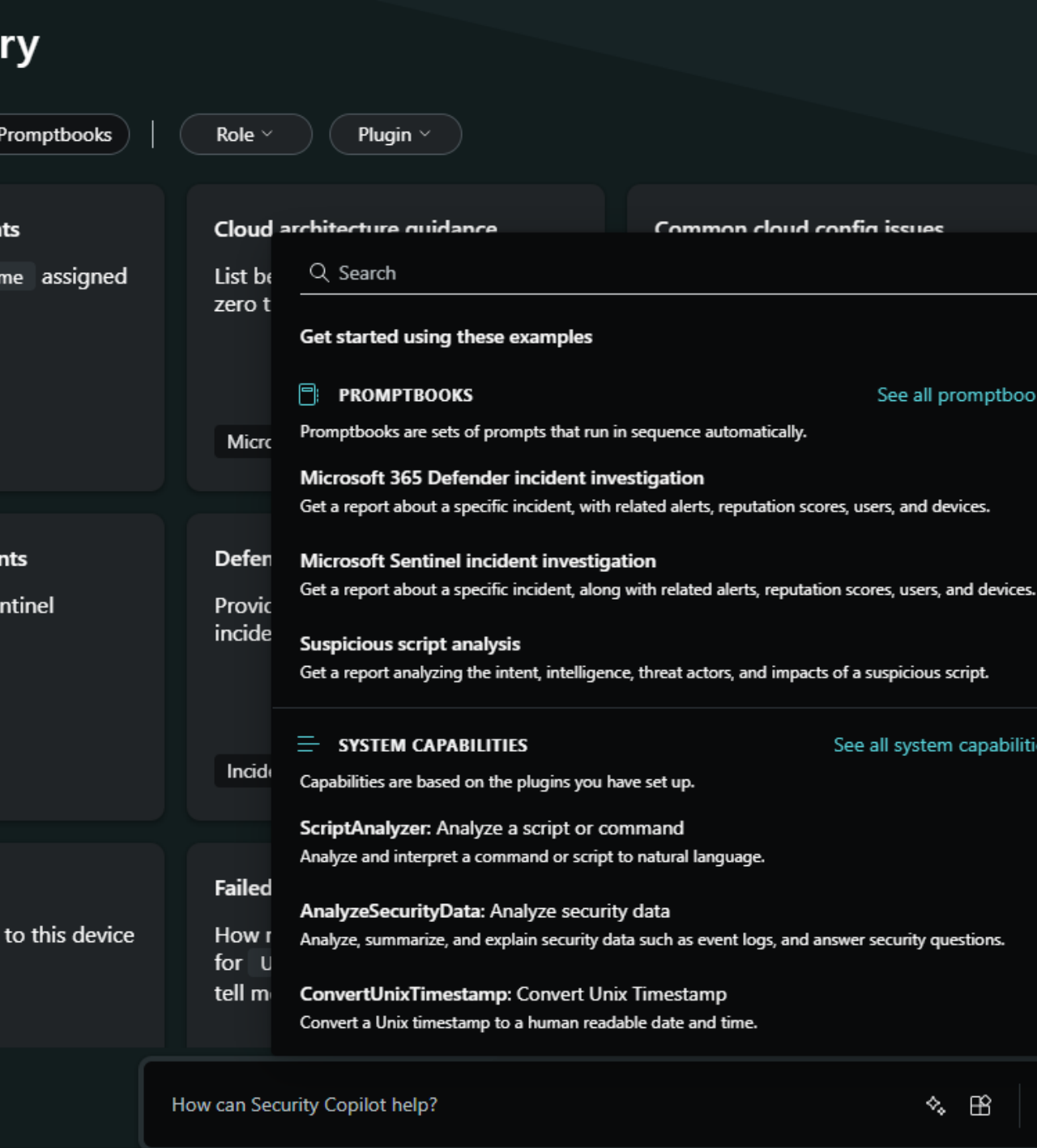
UTILIZING SECURITY COPILOT IN LOGIC APPS

Intelligent Query Formulation

Security Copilot assists analysts by providing intelligent prompts that facilitate the formulation of effective queries.

Efficiency in Analysis

The prompts enhance the efficiency of analysts in extracting relevant information from Sentinel incidents, streamlining the analysis process.



BEST PRACTICES FOR UTILIZING SECURITY COPILOT

Clear Prompts

Provide clear and concise prompts for accurate results.

Familiarization

Understand Security Copilot's features to enhance workflows.

Workflow Enhancement

Implement best practices for effective investigations.

EFFECTIVE PROMPTING

What = Goal

Specific, security-related information that you need.

Why = Context

Why you need this information or how you'll use it.

How = Expectations

Format or target audience you want the response tailored to.

Where = Source

Known information, data source(s), or plugins Security Copilot should use.

Poor Prompt:

Write Something

What's wrong with it: The prompt is too vague and does not provide any context or specific instructions for the AI.

Improved Prompt:

Write a report about a Microsoft Sentinel Incident <Incident_No> that can be reviewed by my SOC team manager, Lee Majors

Why it's better: The prompt is specific, provides a clear context, and guides the AI towards a particular task.

Poor Prompt:

Summarize this.

What's wrong with it: The prompt lacks detail on what needs to be summarized and the desired length or style of the summary.

Improved Prompt:

Provide a one-paragraph summary of the key points from the Microsoft Sentinel Incident number: <Incident_No>.

Why it's better: The prompt specifies the document to summarize, the focus on key points, and the expected length.

WHY AUTOMATE WITH PLAYBOOKS INSTEAD OF USING COPILOT STANDALONE?

Standalone Experience

The standalone experience is shown as a separate application window. It features a dark theme with a blue header. The main content area is titled "Security Copilot agents are here" and includes a "Go to agents" button. Below this, there's a "Prompts to try" section with a search bar and filters for "Prompts", "Promptbooks", "Role", and "Plugin". The prompts are organized into a grid of cards, each with a title, description, and a source link. The cards include:

- Application assignments**: What groups is Appname assigned to? (Microsoft Intune)
- Cloud architecture guidance**: List best practices for implementing zero trust architecture in the cloud. (Microsoft Documentation)
- Common cloud config issues**: List common cloud security misconfigurations and how to avoid them. (Microsoft Documentation)
- Critical Sentinel incidents**: What are the critical Sentinel incidents right now? (Microsoft Sentinel)
- Defender incident summary**: Provide a summary of Defender
- Device comparison**: Compare this device with another
- Device group memberships**: What groups is device name a
- Failed user log-ins**: How many failed sign-ins occurred

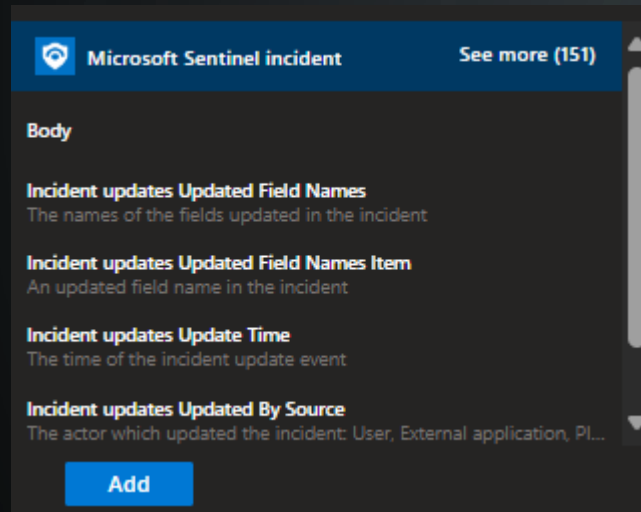
At the bottom, there's a search bar with the text "How can Security Copilot help?" and a "Go" button.

Embedded Experience

The embedded experience is shown as a screenshot of the Microsoft Defender console. The interface is light-themed and displays a detailed view of an incident titled "SAP financial process manipulation attack disrupted". The incident is marked as "High" and "Active". The left sidebar shows a list of alerts, with the selected alert being "A potentially malicious URL click was detected". The main content area shows a timeline of events, a network diagram, and a list of impacted assets. The right sidebar contains the "Security Copilot" panel, which provides a summary of the incident, recommended actions, and a "Classify as BEC financial fraud multi-stage attack" button. The bottom of the console shows a list of related incidents.

SECURITY COPILOT EXPERIENCE

Standalone Experience	Embedded Experience	Logic App Integration
• Foundational for Understanding Capability • Ask Questions, Get Summaries • Fully Analyst-Driven	• Auto adds context and suggestions • Guided Experience • Requires Human Interaction	• Automated and Customizable • Operates 24/7 • Repeatable and Scalable • Outputs can be routed.



INCIDENT VARIABLES TO QUERYING AGAINST

Grounding Information

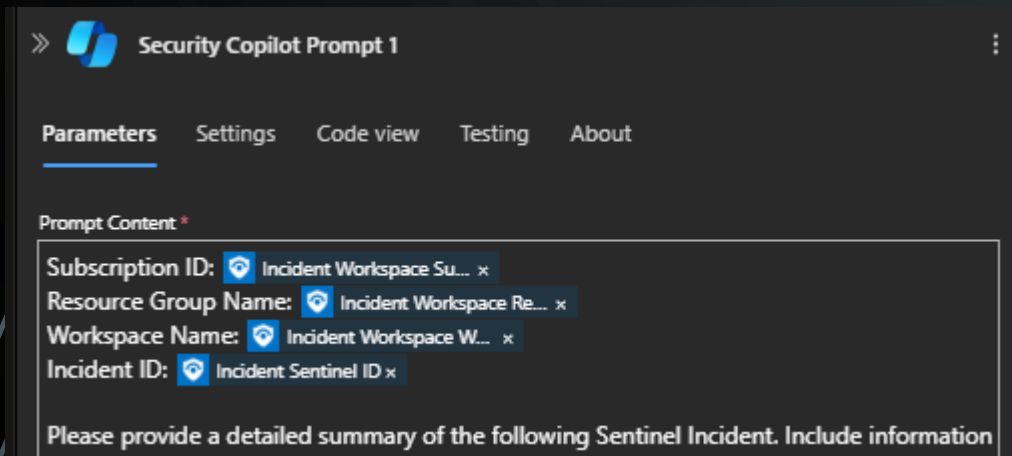
Unique identifier for the incident, used to track and reference specific incidents.

Incident Entities

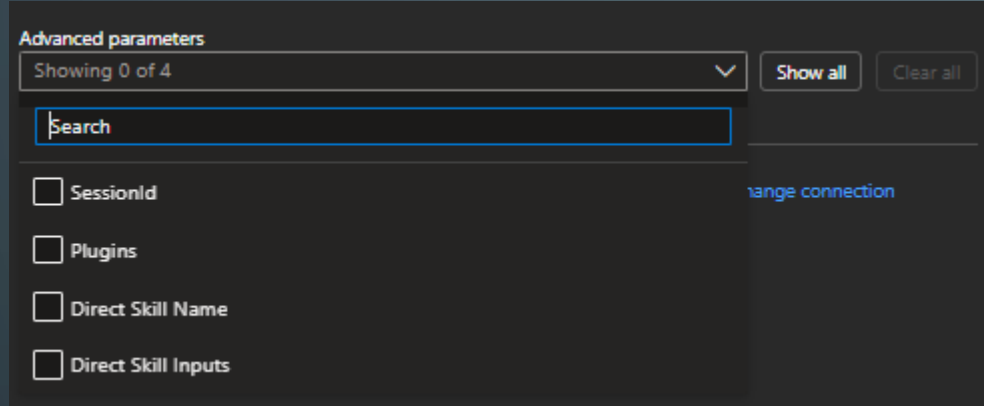
Details about entities involved in the incident, such as accounts, IP addresses, hosts, URLs, and file hashes.

Alert Details

Information about the alerts that triggered the incident, including severity, description, and timestamp.



THINGS YOU SHOULD KNOW



Session ID

Allows you to have one ongoing conversation with Security Copilot, or many ongoing conversations at once.

Plugins

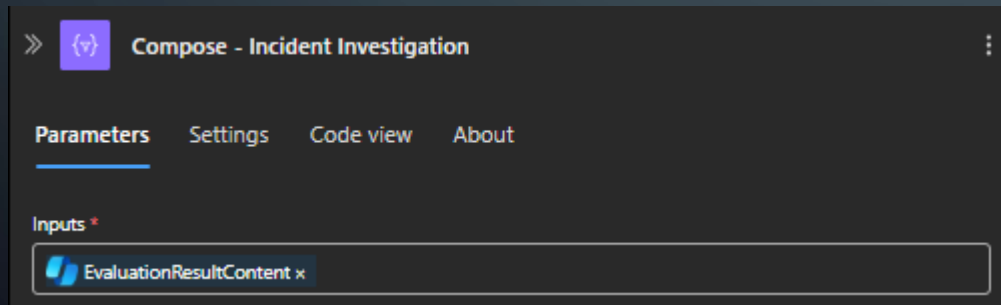
Specify plugins to avoid collisions and scope down potential choices.

Direct Skill Name

Trigger a specific skill directly, bypassing the standard planner.

Direct Skill Inputs

Provide a JSON body with key/value pairs for skill parameters.



'EvaluationResultContent'

This is the output of which Security Copilot returns a response. This is what will be used in your Output

OUTPUTTING SECURITY COPILOT RESPONSES AS A SENTINEL ACTIONABLE OR NOTIFICATIONS

Incident Comment Update

Automate comment generation in Sentinel incidents.

Incident Task Creation

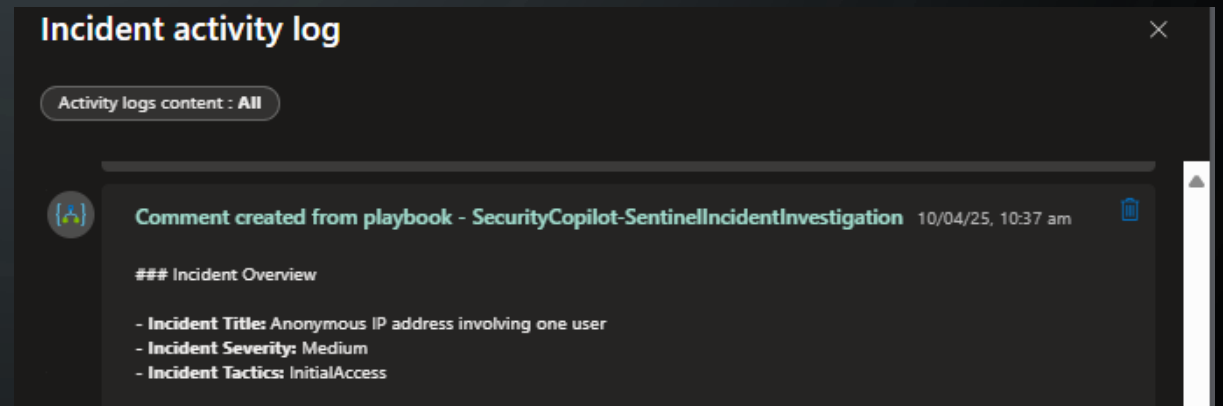
Automatically create tasks based on incident analysis.

Notifications

Send email and Teams notifications for timely responses.

Third Party Integration

Integrate with PagerDuty for enhanced incident management.





AUTOMATION SCENARIOS AND USE CASES

Incident Triage

Analyze and classify incidents by severity/type. Enrich data with threat intelligence and reputation scores.

Alert Enrichment

Integrate external sources (e.g., AbuseIPDB). Analyze command line elements and processes.

Automated Response

Trigger containment actions (e.g., isolate devices, block IPs). Update incident comments in real-time.

Task Automation

Auto-create and assign tasks based on analysis. Streamline routine investigation steps.

Third-Party Integration

Integrate with tools like PagerDuty for enhanced management.

Create new automation rule

Automation rule name *

AutomationRule1

Trigger

When incident is created

Conditions

If

Severity

▼

Equals

▼

High

AND

Status

▼

Equals

▼

New

+ Add

▼

Actions ⓘ

Run playbook

END TO END PROCESS

Create a Playbook

Playbook with a Trigger, Blank Playbook

Define your Playbook Triggers

Incident, Alert, Entity

Configure your Automation Rule

Title, Severity, Status, Tactic (MITRE ATT&CK)

>> Security Copilot Prompt 1

Parameters

Settings

Code view

Testing

Prompt Content *

Subscription ID:  Incident Workspace Su... ✕

Resource Group Name:  Incident Workspace R

Workspace Name:  Incident Workspace W... ✕

Incident ID:  Incident Sentinel ID ✕

Please provide a detailed summary of the foll

END TO END PROCESS

Ground your Security Copilot Investigation

- Subscription ID
- Resource Group Name
- Sentinel Workspace Name
- Sentinel Incident ID

Utilize Security Copilot in your Investigation

- AI-Powered Analysis
- Integrates Defender Threat Intelligence
- Seamless Integration
- Real-Time Updates

Determine your Output

- Sentinel Comment
- Sentinel Task
- Teams/Email Notification
- Third-Party Integration

Parameters

Settings

Code view

Testing

About

Prompt Content *

Subscription ID:  Incident Workspace Subscription ID ✕

Resource Group Name:  Incident Workspace Resource Group Name ✕

Workspace Name:  Incident Workspace Workspace Name ✕

Incident ID:  Incident Sentinel ID ✕

Please provide a detailed summary of the following Sentinel Incident. Include information related to the entities involved and any relevant information that can assist in the investigation. Correlate information from both Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender XDR

Advanced parameters

Search



Show all

Clear all

 Connected to SecurityCopilotSecurityCopilot-SentinelIncidentInvestigation.

[Change connection](#)

Parameters Settings Code view Testing About

Prompt Content *

If there are any host entities associated with this incident, please provide relevant information about those entities that would be useful for the investigation.

Advanced parameters

Showing 1 of 4



Show all

Clear all

SessionId

 sessionId x



 Connected to SecurityCopilotSecurityCopilot-SentinelIncidentInvestigation.

[Change connection](#)

Parameters Settings Code view Testing About

Prompt Content *

For any process entities involved in this incident, please provide detailed information about the processes that can assist in the investigation.

Advanced parameters

Showing 1 of 4



Show all

Clear all

SessionId

 sessionId x



 Connected to SecurityCopilotSecurityCopilot-SentinelIncidentInvestigation.

[Change connection](#)



Compose - Incident Data



Parameters

Settings

Code view

About

Inputs *

Incident Title:  Incident Title ✕ ,

Incident Description:  Incident Description ✕ ,

Incident Severity:  Incident Severity ✕ ,

Incident Tactics:  Incident Tactics ✕ ,

Incident and Account Analysis:  EvaluationResultContent ✕ ,

Device Analysis:  EvaluationResultContent ✕ ,

Process Analysis:  EvaluationResultContent ✕

Prompt Content *

Here is the security incident detail which you have provided as part of this investigation:  **Outputs** 

Please only show relevant information related to this incident to aid in further investigation. This will act as a triage process for our SOC Team.

Perform another investigation over the incident and output in the following order:

1. Incident Overview
2. Incident Description
3. Breakdown of analyzed entities (Accounts, IP Addresses, Hosts, and Processes, where applicable)
4. Possible Mitigation Steps
5. Conclusion

Please format the contents appropriately for a Sentinel Comment, as the output will be used to update an incident with a comment within Microsoft Sentinel.

>>

 Add Investigation Notes to Incident

⋮

ParametersSettingsCode viewTestingAbout

Incident ARM Id *

 Incident ARM ID

×

Incident Comment Message *

↺

↻

Normal

▼

Arial

▼

15px

▼

B

I

U

A

◀

▶

 Outputs

×

>>

 Update Incident - Status Active

⋮

ParametersSettingsCode viewTestingAbout

Incident ARM Id *

 Incident ARM ID

×

Tags To Add

+

Add new item



Assign/Unassign Owner

Assign or unassign incident owner

▼

Owner Object Id / UPN

Unique identifier of a user (Ex. 'user@tenant.onmicrosoft.com...)

Severity

Incident severity

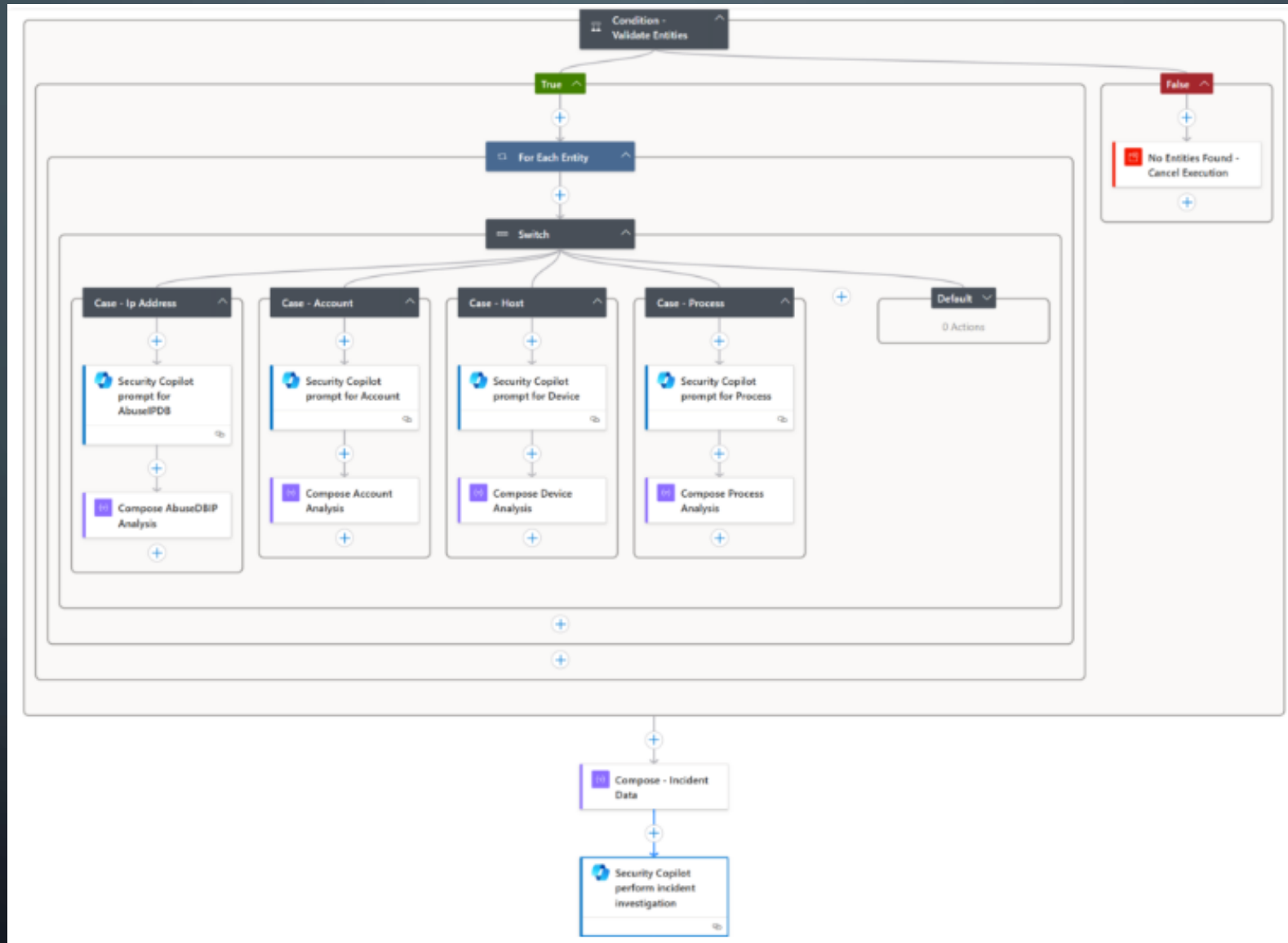
▼

Status

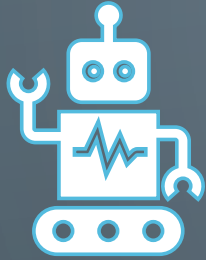
Active

▼

NEED INSPIRATION? CHECK OUT GITHUB!



IN CONCLUSION



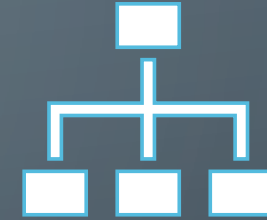
Triage Automation

Security Copilot enhances incident management with fast, intelligent responses.



SOAR

Streamlines workflows and boosts security operations efficiency.



Operational Efficiency

Elevates security teams' efficiency, education, and incident management capabilities.

Anthony Porter
Cloud Security Architect
Canon Business Services ANZ

Blog: <https://www.securingm365.com>

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/AnthonyAntoPorter>

GitHub: <https://www.github.com/AntoPorter>

Podcast: Out of Band: A Microsoft Security Podcast